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Repetitiousness and vanity: we waited for these characteristics to show as he began his story. Obviously, he had been ^{Coached.} ~~cracked~~. His answers were brief, convincing. He could go back to long before 1933, he said, to explain his interest in other countries. During the last days of the Weimar  Republic, he had traveled mainly for pleasure: "I liked to travel and I wanted to see the world." By 1930 his travel-reports to the Statistics Department of Berlin Northwest 7 (VOWI) had become so authoritative that the Foreign Office of the Bruening Government had begun to use them. ~~His uncle~~ Hermann Schmitz had been economics advisor to the

~~Reichs~~ Reichschancellor Bruening, and he took along Max's studies to the World Economics and Reparations Conference, held in London, which led to the Hoover Moratorium on debts. Schmitz told ^{Ilgnier} ~~him~~ later that his material was better than that of any of the other delegations. All Europe was floundering in depression, and as the beginning of a way out his office had published, by 1932, a four-volume work called, "Economic Elementary Comparison between the United States of America, England, France, Italy and Germany." European economists were seriously considering ways of making all Europe independent of the outside world, in food, raw materials

and finished products, ~~etc~~. But while ^{did not agree.} The Farben economists headed by Schmitz and Ilgnier ~~were~~ basing their ^{predictions of} ~~view~~ ^{independence} ~~that Europe~~ ^{they based their view on the} ~~based on a rich foreign market for the moderately~~ priced Farben sodas and aspirins and atabrine and dyes and plastics, ^{and this view was supported} ~~the scientists~~ ^{by} ~~had created~~ ^{Farben} ~~who~~ their white commercial elephants out of coal, water and air. Despite the analysis of Dr. ter Meer